

ix. Coastal Regions

(a) Indian Coastline

*India is surrounded by water on three sides. The length of the Indian Coastline is **7516.6 km.** (According to data from the 1970s). According to re-verified data in 2023, the total length of India's coastline is 11098.81 km. The Indian coastline extends from Bay of Bengal in the east to Indian Ocean in the south and the Arabian Sea in the west. *India has a coastline that touches **13 States and Union Territories.**

Sl No.	State / UTs	Length (1970s data)	Re-verified length (2023)
1.	Gujarat	1214.7 km.	2340.62 km.
2.	Maharashtra	652.6 km.	877.97 km.
3.	Goa	101 km.	193.95 km.
4.	Karnataka	280 km.	343.30 km.
5.	Kerala	569.7 km.	600.15 km.
6.	Tamil Nadu	906.9 km.	1068.69 km.
7.	Andhra Pradesh	973.7 km.	1053.07 km.
8.	Odisha	476.4 km.	574.71 km.
9.	West Bengal	157.5 km.	721.02 km.
10.	Dadra and Nagar Haveli & Daman and Diu	42.5 km.	54.38 km.
11.	Lakshadweep	132 km.	144.80 km.
12.	Puducherry	47.6 km.	42.65 km.
13.	Andaman and Nicobar Islands	1962 km.	3083.50 km.
	Total	7516.6 km.	11098.81 km.



*The length of the coastline touching the mainland of the country is **5422.6 km** (Now- 7870.51 km.) long. whereas the coastline away from the mainland is **2094 km** (Now- 3228.3 km.) long. *The state of **Gujarat** has the longest coastline whereas that of **Goa** is the shortest. The coastline or the seashore, is the area where land meets the sea or the ocean or a line that forms the boundary between the land and ocean, which is often called the ground line. *The territorial waters of a country are known as its territorial sea. The range of the territorial sea of any country is measured from its coastline, towards the open ocean. Commonly it is somewhere around **12 nautical miles**. India has complete and sovereign rights over this region. The contiguous zone extends **24 nautical miles** from the baseline towards the open ocean. In this zone India has the right to collect customs duty and also carry out economic activities. *The exclusive economic zone of any country extends **200 nautical miles** from the baseline towards the open ocean. In this zone, India is allowed to conduct scientific researches.

1. Based on following statements choose the correct option:

Statement - I : Theory of Plate tectonics was given by H.H. Hess in 1967.

Statement - II : Theory of Plate Tectonics is based on Theory of Seafloor Spreading.

- (a) Statement - I and Statement - II both are true
- (b) Statement - I and Statement- II both are false
- (c) Statement - I is true but Statement - II is false
- (d) Statement - I is false but Statement - II is true

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (d)

The concept of plate tectonics was formulated in the 1960s. Wilson, Morgan, Parker, McKenzie, Harry Hess etc. contributed to the development of this theory. The theory of plate tectonics is based on the ocean floor spreading theory.

2. From which of the following coasts the mean sea level of India is measured ?

- (a) Mumbai
- (b) Chennai
- (c) Kochi
- (d) Visakhapatnam

U.P.U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (b)

The mean sea level of India is measured with reference to the Chennai coast.

3. The limit of the territorial water of India extends up to:

- (a) 3 nautical miles from the coast
- (b) 6 nautical miles from the coast
- (c) 12 nautical miles from the coast
- (d) 24 nautical miles from the coast

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2005

Ans. (c)

Territorial waters in the area of the sea immediately adjacent to the shore of a state are subject to the territorial jurisdiction of that state. This area is generally 12 nautical miles.

4. What is the total length of coastal line of India?

- (a) 3500 km
- (b) 800 km
- (c) 6000 km
- (d) 7500 km

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2003

Ans. (d)

India is surrounded by sea on three sides. The length of it's total coastline is 7516.6 km (Now- 11098.81 km.) India's coastline consists of Bay of Bengal in the east, Indian Ocean in south and Arabian Sea in the west.

Sl No.	State / UTs	Length (1970s data)	Re-verified length (2023)
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Total		7516.6 km.	11098.81 km.

5. Coastal line of India is –

- (a) 6,200 km long
- (b) 6,100 km long
- (c) 5,985 km long
- (d) 6,175 km long

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (*)

See the explanation of the above question.

6. Which of the following States of India has the longest coastline?

- (a) Maharashtra
- (b) Andhra Pradesh
- (c) Kerala
- (d) Gujarat

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of the above question.

7. Which of the following Indian states has the longest sea coast ?

- (a) Andhra Pradesh
- (b) Maharashtra
- (c) Gujarat
- (d) Tamil Nadu

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1995, 2014

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2006

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Mains) 2006

U.P.U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2006

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2007

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

8. Which of the following State has longest coast line of India?

- (a) Andhra Pradesh
- (b) Gujarat
- (c) Tamil Nadu
- (d) Kerala

U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) (Re-Exam) 2016

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

9. In India, how many States share the coastline?

- (a) 7
- (b) 8
- (c) 9
- (d) 10

I.A.S. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

10. During ancient Indian historical geography, the term 'Ratnakara' denoted –

- (a) The Arabian Sea
- (b) The Bay of Bengal
- (c) The Indian Ocean
- (d) The Confluence of the Ganga, the Jamuna and the mythical Saraswati in Prayag.

I.A.S. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (c)

In ancient Indian historical geography the Indian Ocean has been named as "Ratnakara" - a place where gems and jewels are found.

11. Maximum Coastal erosion is caused by :

- (a) Waves
- (b) Tides